RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

18 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 11:55 AM, Sunday 18 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 364 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 42 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 9,511 minutes at 12:00 PM; Dammam landings only in the last hour, no takeoff since 10:43 AM

INCIDENT SUMMARY

1 What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 9,511 minutes at 12:00 PM; GACA has not announced a reopening**.
- No Riyadh takeoff or landing in the last hour; 364 flights cancelled for Sunday so far (63% of scheduled).
- Riyadh airport's official account tells passengers to follow official authorities and contact their airline; The National reports a reopening, but the board shows no movement.
- Bahrain's foreign minister condemns continued Houthi attacks on the Kingdom and its airports at the GCC meeting in Manama; no new official attack report since 3:16 AM.
- Dammam airport landing only: 0 takeoffs and 3 landings in the last hour, latest flynas XY897 from Lucknow at 11:50 AM; no takeoff since flyadeal F3304 to Jeddah at 10:43 AM.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (9506 min).

364	0/0	1
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

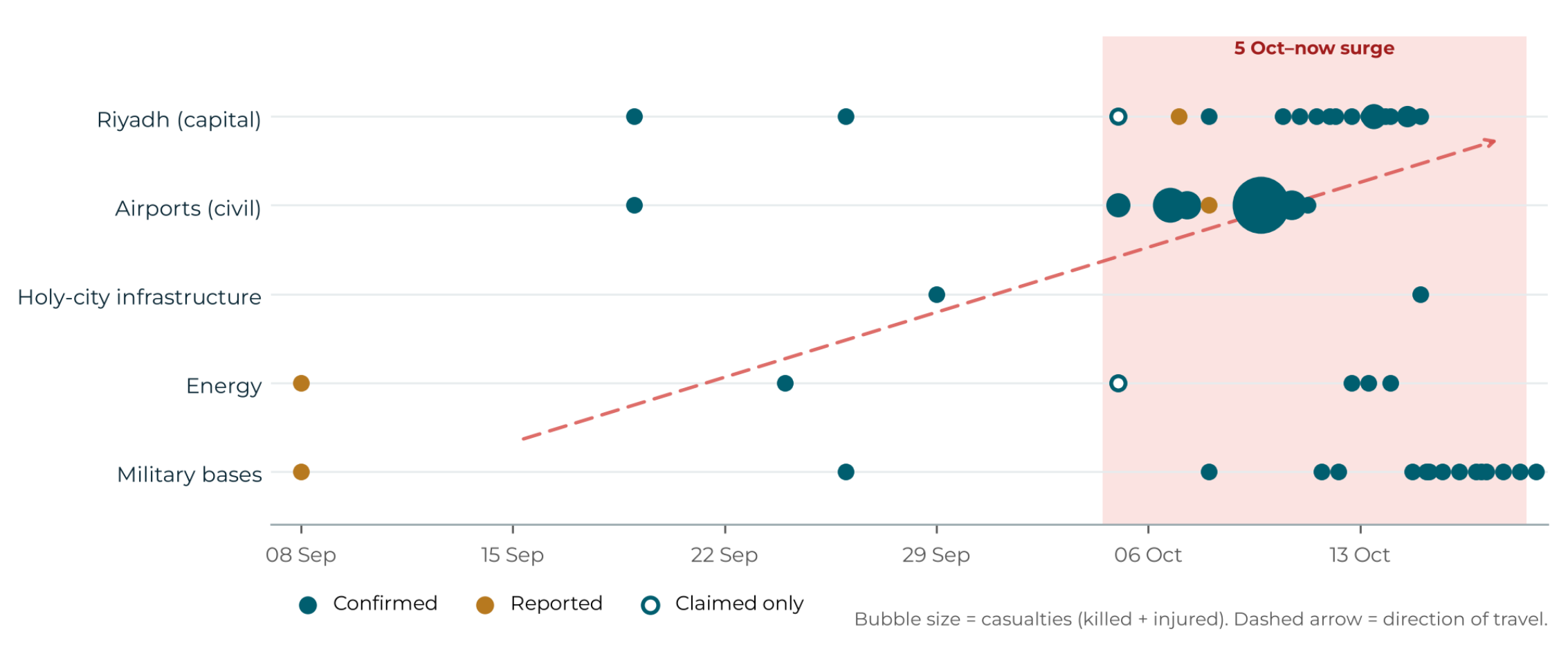
0 takeoffs and 3 landings in the last hour.

42	0/3	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct (9,511 min at 12:00 PM); no GACA reopening announcement
- Riyadh airport's account told passengers at 11:02 and 11:07 AM to follow official authorities and contact their airline
- Bahrain's foreign minister condemned continued Houthi attacks on the Kingdom and its airports at the GCC meeting in Manama (11:50 AM)
- Dammam landings only: 3 landings, no takeoff in the last hour; last takeoff flyadeal F3304 at 10:43 AM
- No new official attack or interception report since 3:16 AM

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 18 OCT



50 sourced events since 8 September (44 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed in Riyadh region (18 Oct, Coalition spokesman / SPA / Al Ekhbariya; none reported (intercept)). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

2 Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 11:00 AM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

No new attacks, interceptions or alerts since 11:00 AM AST.

Last 24 hours: Interceptions 5, alerts 4, all-clears 4, casualty reports 1.

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

3 Riyadh airport still halted; Bahrain condemns attacks at GCC meeting; airlines keep suspensions

Checked at 11:56 AM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **Bahrain's foreign minister condemns continued Houthi attacks on the Kingdom and its airports at GCC ministerial meeting**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **11:50 AM** · published 11:46 and 11:50 AM AST Sun 18 Oct (official account); checked 11:54 AM

Speaking at the 168th GCC ministerial council meeting in Manama, Bahrain's foreign minister said Bahrain condemns the continued Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia and its airports. He added that Gulf security is indivisible and an attack on any Gulf state is an attack on all of them.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh airport tells passengers to follow official authorities for airspace updates and contact their airline**

King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **11:07 AM** · replies posted 11:02 and 11:07 AM AST Sun 18 Oct to passengers asking whether flights have resumed; checked 11:54 AM

Asked on X whether King Khalid airport is receiving flights again, the airport's official account told passengers to follow the competent official authorities for the latest airspace updates and to contact the airline they booked with. It did not announce a reopening.

UNVERIFIED **The National reports Riyadh airport reopened Sunday, but many airlines keep Saudi suspensions**

The National · **10:53 AM** · published 10:53 AM AST Sun 18 Oct; no GACA reopening statement found and the Flightradar24 board still shows no Riyadh movements; checked 11:56 AM

The National says King Khalid airport reopened on Sunday, but lists carriers still suspended: Etihad and flydubai to 19 October, Oman Air to 22 October, Air France and Air India to 24 October, SalamAir to 31 October, Cathay Pacific to 31 January 2027, and Qatar Airways with no date. The flight board does not yet show any Riyadh takeoff or landing.

UNVERIFIED **Ministry of Education keeps Riyadh and Diriyah schools on remote learning through 22 October**

The Gulf Bulletin (@thegulfbulletin), citing the Ministry of Education · **10:12 AM** · posted 10:12 AM AST Sun 18 Oct; ministry announcement made Saturday, not seen on the ministry's own channel; checked 10:55 AM

The Gulf Bulletin reports the Ministry of Education announced on Saturday that schools in Riyadh city and Diriyah Governorate will stay on remote learning through 22 October as a precaution, with lessons on the Madrasati platform.

UNVERIFIED **Social posts claim Dammam airport was closed and a fire broke out at the Ju'aymah gas plant**

Social accounts on X (@Abraracurs64713, @Prahmatic17) · **9:54 AM** · Earlier post 9:34 AM; checked 10:00 AM

Two social accounts claim Dammam airport was hit or closed this morning and that satellites show an unusual fire at the Ju'aymah gas plant and port near Ras Tanura. No official source confirms either. The Flightradar24 board shows no Dammam takeoff or landing from 8:17 to 9:18 AM, then traffic resumed.

CLAIM **Houthi spokesman claims a Saudi Caracal drone was shot down over Hajjah, Yemen**

Yahya Saree, reported by Hurriyat (@HurriyatEN) · **8:42 AM** · posted 8:42 AM AST Sun 18 Oct; Houthi claim, no coalition comment; checked 9:00 AM

Houthi military spokesman Yahya Saree claims his forces shot down a Saudi Caracal drone over Hajjah province, which he called the fourth downed so far. The coalition has not commented, and the claim is not independently verified.

CORROBORATED **Aviation accounts say the Riyadh closure notice expired, but arrivals and departures still need prior permission**

Trips N' Maps (@tripsNmapsX), FlightCore Info (@FlightCoreinfos), The Contrail · **8:37 AM** · first posted 7:10 AM, repeated by FlightCore Info at 8:37 AM AST Sun 18 Oct; no GACA statement; checked 9:00 AM

Two aviation-tracking accounts and The Contrail say the closure NOTAM for King Khalid International expired at midnight on 17 October, but new notices require prior permission for every arrival and departure and bar its use as an alternate. GACA has not announced a reopening, and the Flightradar24 board still shows no Riyadh movements.

CONFIRMED **SPA: weather service warns of thunderstorms, hail and fog, including coastal parts of the Eastern Province**

SPA (@SPAregions) · **7:00 AM** · published 7:00 AM AST Sun 18 Oct (official account, translated from Arabic); checked 9:00 AM

The national weather service expects moderate to heavy thunderstorms with flash floods, hail and strong winds over Jazan, Asir, Al Baha and Makkah, with fog forming there and on the coastal parts of the Eastern Province, where Dammam airport is.

CONFIRMED **Philippines: first 34 Filipino workers from Riyadh due home on Monday as more await flights**

Philippine News Agency (@pnagovph) · **6:51 AM** · published 6:51 AM AST Sun 18 Oct (Philippine government news agency); checked 9:00 AM

The Philippine News Agency says the first batch of 34 overseas Filipino workers from Riyadh is expected to arrive on Monday, with the government arranging repatriation of hundreds more.

CONFIRMED **Coalition spokesman rejects Houthi claim that a Saudi Apache was shot down**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox); Arab News · **6:40 AM** · posted 6:40 AM AST Sun 18 Oct; Arab News report 6:58 AM; checked 9:00 AM

The coalition spokesman's account said the Houthis 'claim to have shot it down' and that the Apache 'will enter the field soon'. Arab News reported the spokesman denied the Houthi shoot-down claim; the coalition says the Najran crash was a technical fault.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: National Guard reconnaissance helicopter crashed in Najran region from a technical fault; both officers killed**

Coalition spokesman via SPA (@SPAregions) and Al Ekhbariya · **6:12 AM** · published 6:11 to 6:12 AM AST Sun 18 Oct; SPA at 7:12 AM confirmed the AH-6i belonged to the National Guard Ministry; checked 9:00 AM

Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki Al-Maliki said an AH-6i reconnaissance helicopter of the National Guard crashed in the Najran region because of a technical fault, killing its two-officer crew. The Houthis claim they shot it down; the coalition says it was a malfunction, and there is no independent evidence of a shoot-down.

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

4 Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (9506 min).

364	—	—	0	1
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
193 departures + 171 arrivals, 63% of 577 scheduled.	None on the board.	None on the board.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Dammam.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 11:55 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 364 at 11:55 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	193	171	364	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	193 (63%)	171 (63%)	364	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	0 (0%)	0 (0%)	0	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	2 (100%)	0 (0%)	2	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	0 of 136	0 of 87	0 of 223	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	1	1	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	18	33	51	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	18	23	41	FR24 stats panel

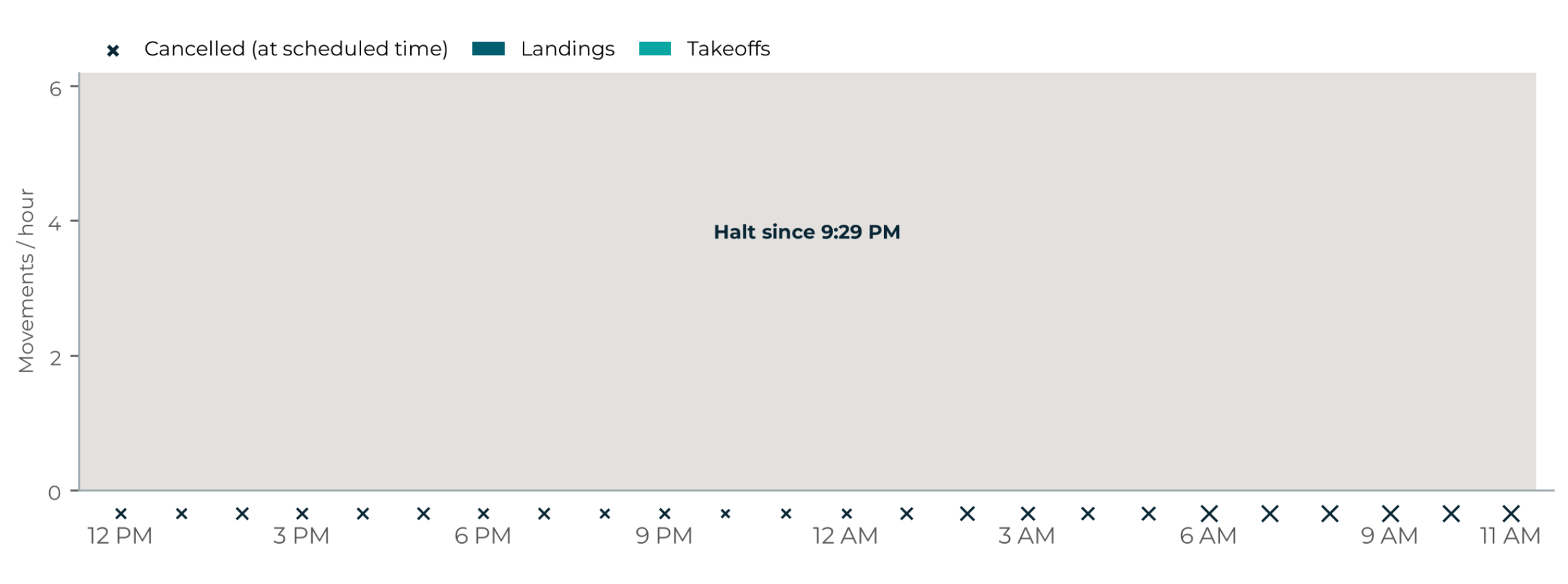
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	221
flynas	71
flyadeal	24
Qatar Airways	13
Riyadh Air	8

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Jeddah	112
Madinah	31
Dubai	24
Dammam	22
Doha	15

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



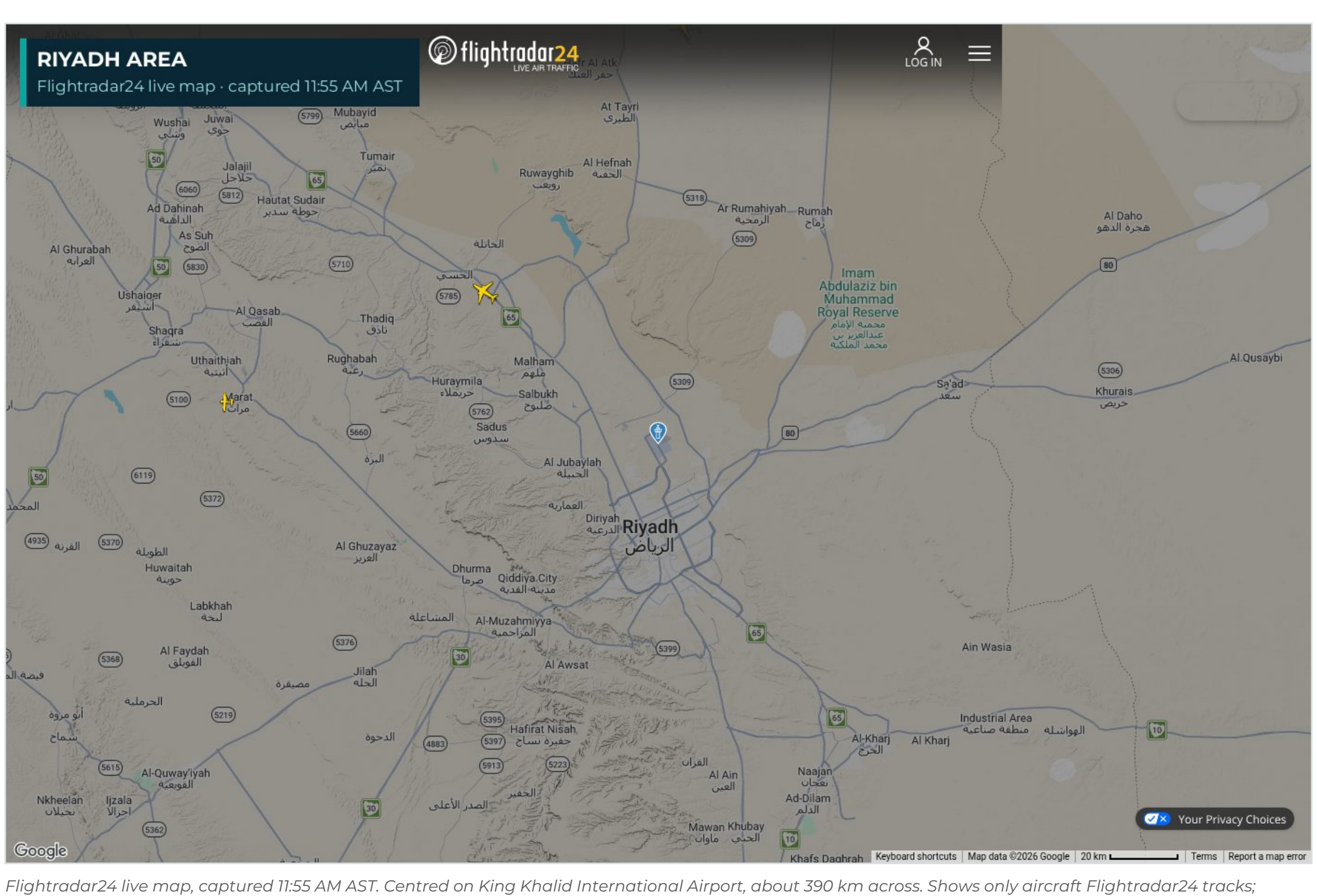
Recorded takeoffs (0) and landings (0) at RUH per hour from 12:00 PM Saturday to 11:55 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct covers the whole window, with no Riyadh movement in it. Dammam's latest halt ran from 8:17 to 9:18 AM; it resumed with Saudia SV1108 landing at 9:18 AM and has kept moving since. Earlier Dammam halts in the window ran 2:49–4:29 AM, 5:09–6:01 PM, 9:42–11:11 PM, 12:17–1:05 AM and 1:15–2:04 AM.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	9506 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 11:55 AM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

5 Dammam airport: disrupted. 0 takeoffs and 3 landings in the last hour.

42	10:43 AM	11:50 AM	0	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
22 departures + 20 arrivals, 19% of 217 scheduled.	F3304 to Jeddah, 71 min before 11:55 AM.	XY897 from Lucknow, 5 min before 11:55 AM.	3 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 11:55 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 42 at 11:55 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	22	20	42	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	22 (20%)	20 (18%)	42	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	13 (12%)	12 (11%)	25	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	11 (46%)	16 (57%)	27	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	14 min	5 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	18 of 44	22 of 47	40 of 91	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	0	0	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	1	4	5	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	15	14	29	FR24 stats panel

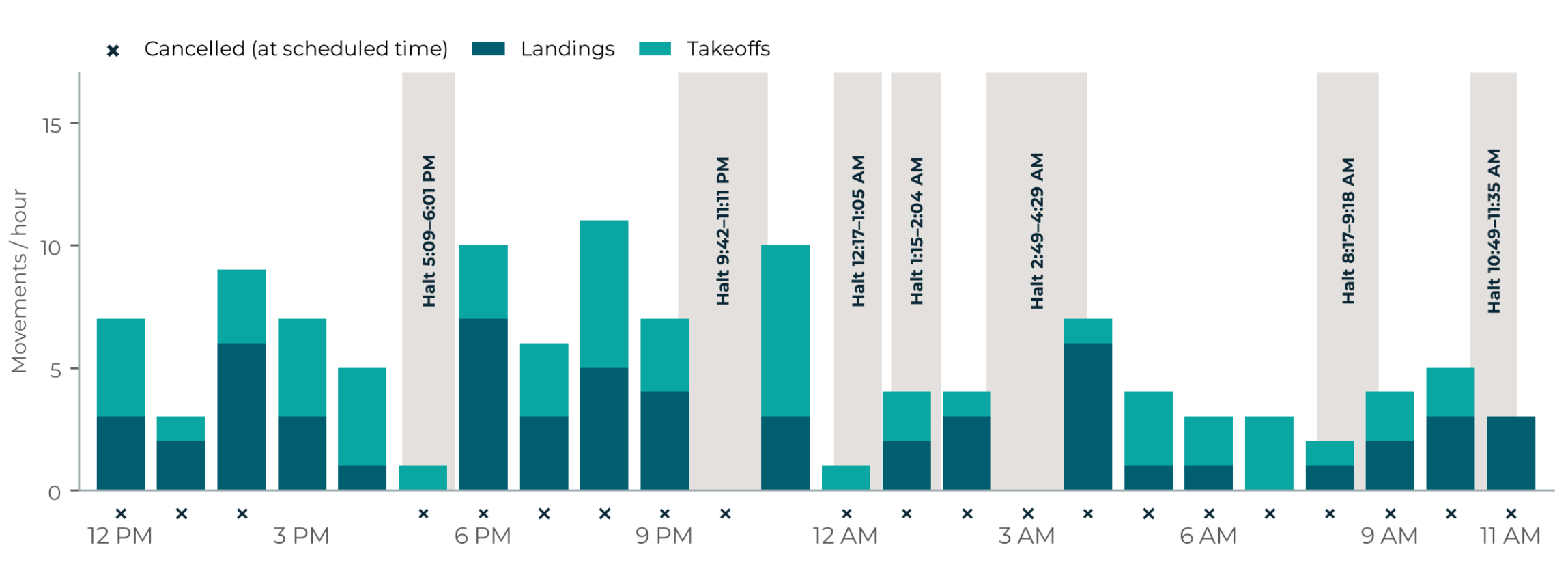
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	22
Egyptair	6
Qatar Airways	6
Turkish Airlines	2
flyadeal	2

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Riyadh	22
Cairo	6
Doha	6
Istanbul	2
Amman	2

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (57) and landings (59) at DMM per hour from 12:00 PM Saturday to 11:55 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Landings only: 0 takeoffs and 3 landings in the last hour. No takeoff since 10:43 AM. Last halt 8:17 to 9:18 AM (61 min).

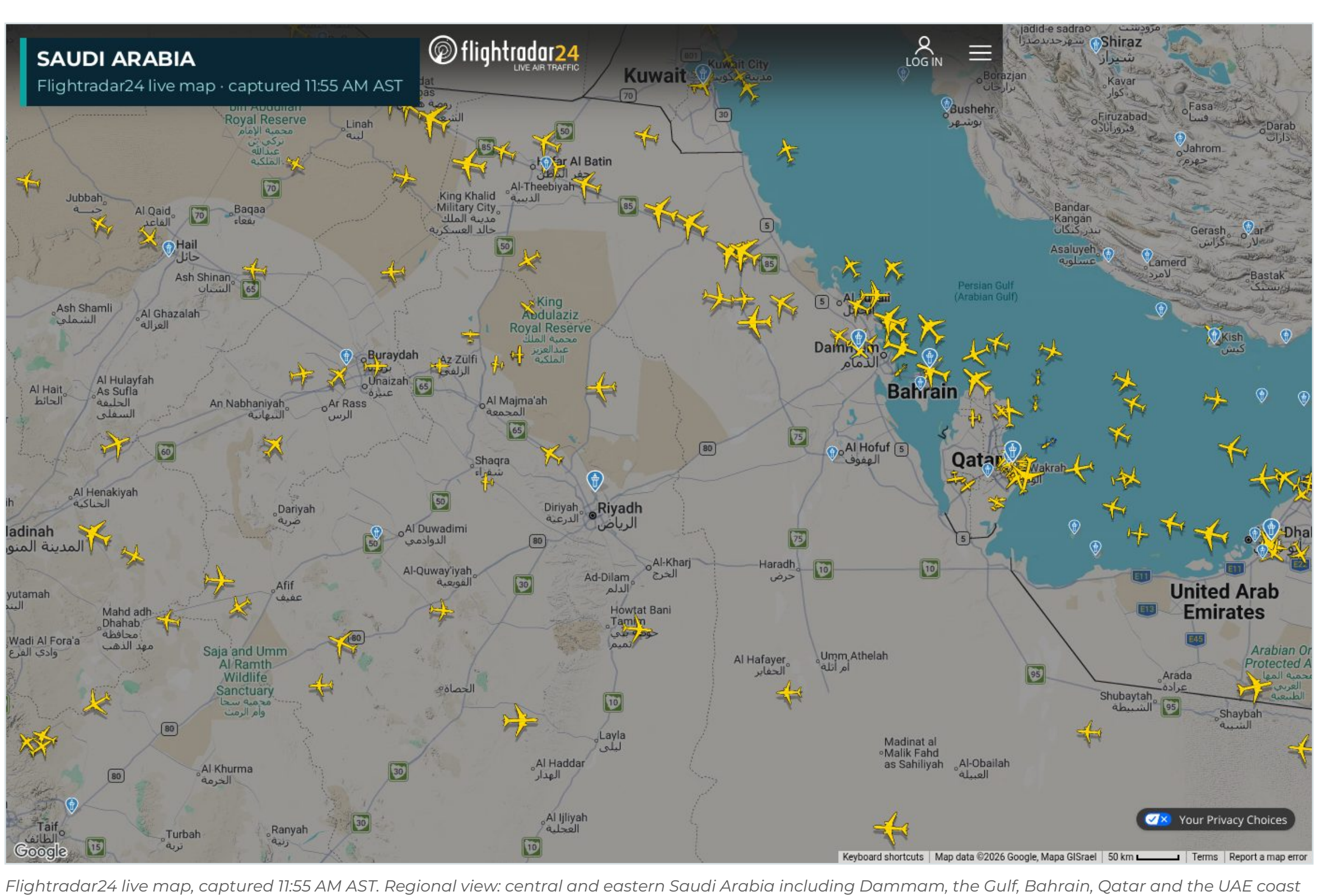
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 10:49–11:35 AM	46 min
Halt 8:17–9:18 AM	61 min
Halt 2:49–4:29 AM	100 min
Halt 1:15–2:04 AM	49 min
Halt 12:17–1:05 AM	48 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

No Dammam airport-specific statement or credible report found in this edition's news check (11:56 AM).

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



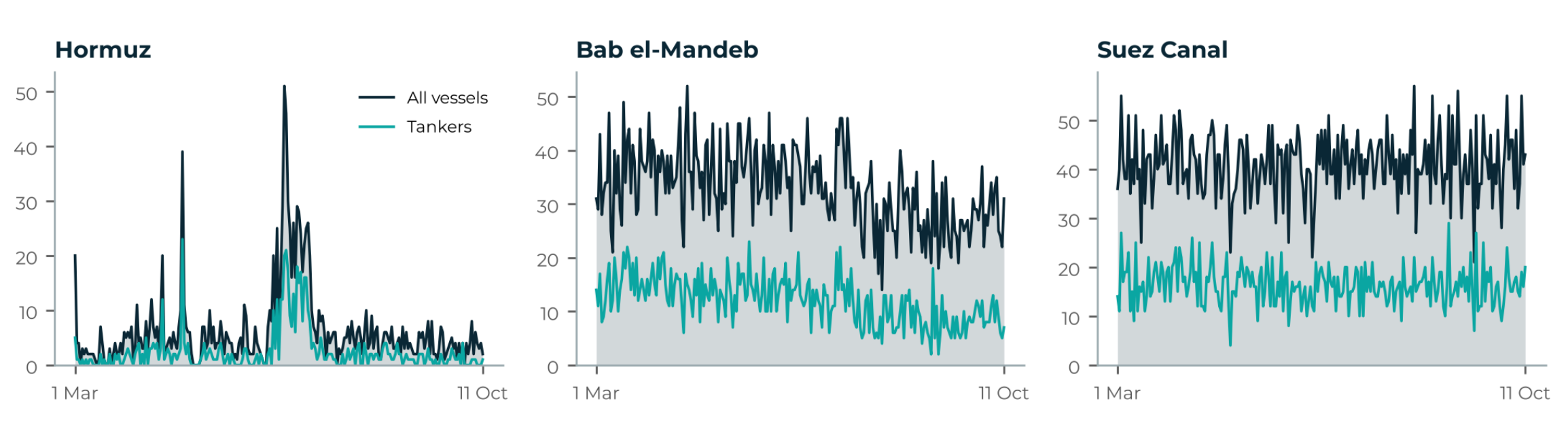
Flightradar24 live map, captured 11:55 AM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

ECONOMY

6 Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

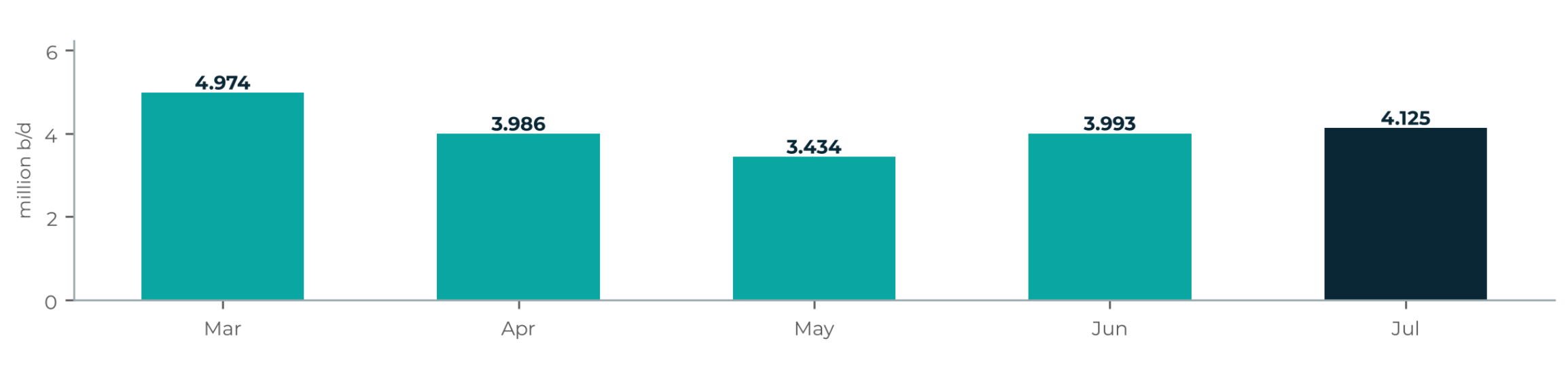
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 11 Oct	**2**	1	1	4.1 (2.7)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 11 Oct	**31**	7	24	28.3 (29.6)
Suez Canal	Sun 11 Oct	**43**	20	23	41.7 (43.1)



Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. ***Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.*** *Fetched 11:56 AM, Sun 18 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

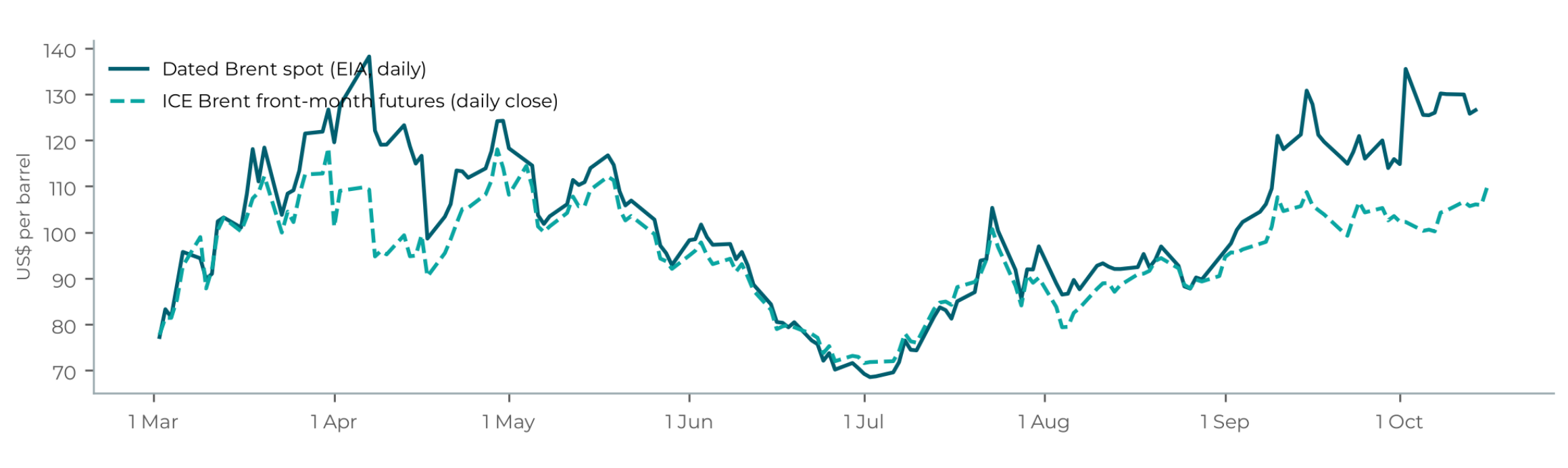


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$109.86	$126.55	+4%	+64%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 11:59 PM, Fri 16 Oct AST (+3.7% on day). Near real time.	Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

METHOD AND LIMITS

7 What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 11:55 AM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
11:55 AM, Sun 18 Oct	11:55 AM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted**	Open sources · not official	1:00 PM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 1:00 PM